



HACKER GUIDE

reNOVAte Create-a-thon

- Colgan Hall, Manassas Campus
- April 18, 2026 | 7:30 AM – 5:30 PM

■ Quick Links & Socials

Join these channels to stay updated during the event!

■	Website	renovatecreateathon.vercel.app
■	Discord	https://discord.com/invite/RnJxNzae73
■	Instagram	@novamacompsci
■	LinkedIn	https://www.linkedin.com/in/nova-cs-club-manassas-4900a73ab/

■ ■ Event Schedule

TIME	EVENT	LOCATION
7:30 – 8:00 AM	Check-ins	2nd Floor Lobby
8:00 – 8:15 AM	Welcome Address	Colgan Theater
8:15 – 9:00 AM	Intro Workshops (Hardware · Scratch · Software)	Student Life Area / Classroom / Theater
9:00 AM – 3:30 PM	Build Time & Optional Workshops	Throughout Colgan Building
12:00 – 12:40 PM	Dominion Energy Presentation + Lunch	Student Life Area
1:00 - 3:30 pm	Scavenger Duck Hunt	Throughout Colgan Building
3:45 – 5:00 PM	Judging & Student Demos	Student Life Area
4:30 – 4:45 PM	Judge Final Decisions	Student Life Classroom
5:00 – 5:30 PM	Closing Ceremony	Colgan Theater

■ What to Bring

ESSENTIALS

- Laptop, Phone & Chargers
- Photo ID (School ID, Driver's License, or Passport)

International students may use a valid school ID.

- Reusable Water Bottle
- Dongles / Adapters

NICE TO HAVE

- Change of Clothes
- Surge Protector
- Raincoat / Umbrella (check Manassas weather!) •
- Resume Printouts (recruiters may be present!)
- Snacks

■ ■ Venue Guide

Colgan Hall, NVCC Manassas Campus

■ **Parking:** Free Parking all lots after 3:45PM and on weekends!

2nd Floor Lobby	Check-In
Colgan Theater	Welcome Address · Closing Ceremony · Software Track
Colgan Classroom	Mentor Briefing · Scratch Track · Workshops
Student Life Area	Hardware Track · Judging · Demos · Lunch
Student Life Classroom	Judging Briefing · Final Decisions

What is reNOVAtE Create-a-thon

ReNOVAtE Create-a-thon is a fast-paced, beginner-friendly 10-hour innovation sprint where 70+ NOVA students work in teams of three to design, build, and present real-world software and hardware prototypes from scratch.

Students will participate in one of three sustainability-focused tracks and be guided through introductory workshops before moving into rapid prototyping. The event concludes with final presentations to faculty and industry guests, along with mini-challenges, hands-on workshops, and fun prizes.

April 18 from 7:30 AM to 5:30 PM
NVCC, Manassas Campus, Colgan Hall

Tracks / Prizes

Software - Amazon Echo Dot

Learn to build websites, design user interfaces, and develop creative digital solutions

Hardware - Portable Monitor

Work with microcontrollers and sensors to create real-world, physical tech projects

We will be Providing Arduino kits to rent for this track

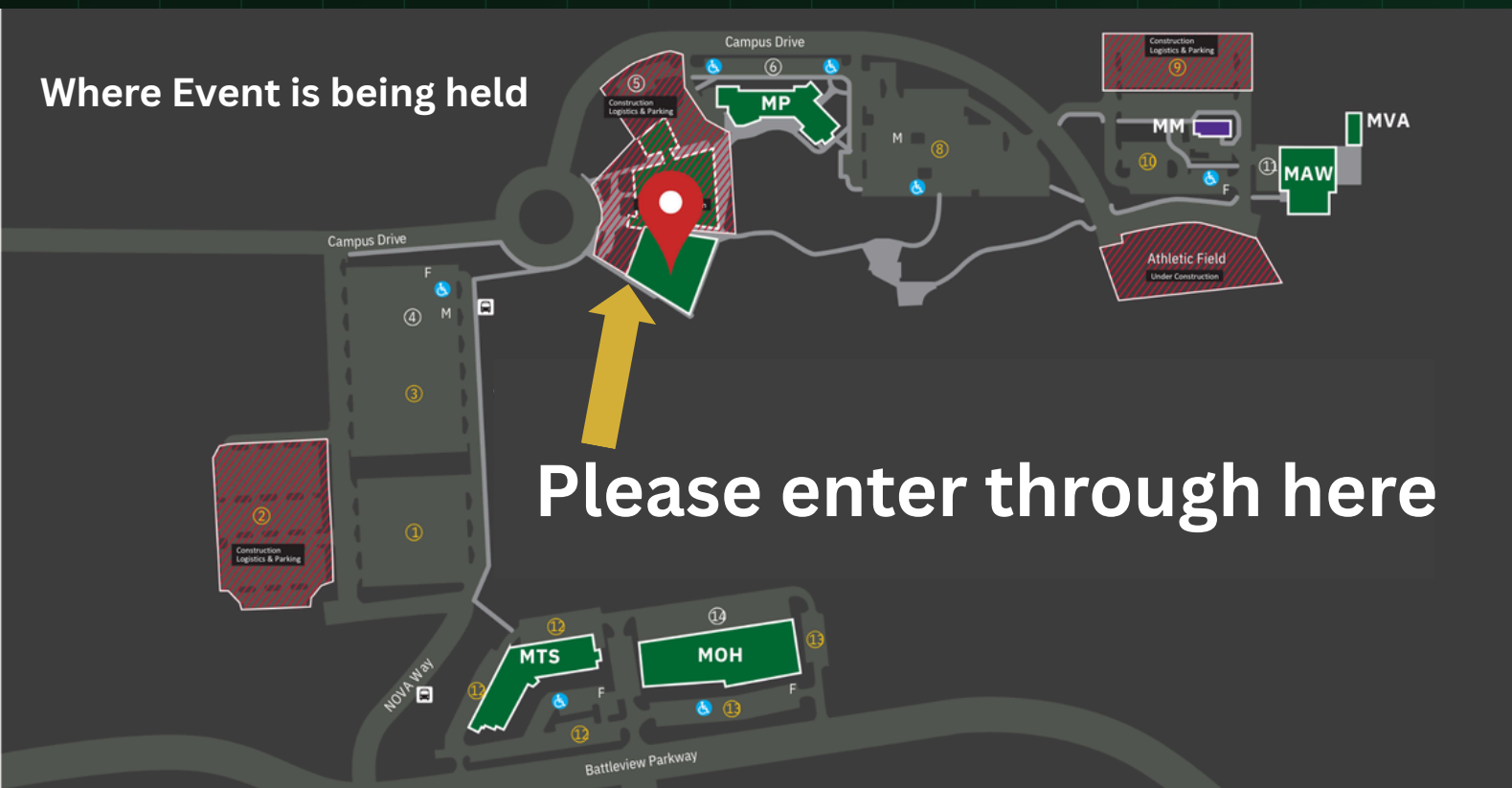
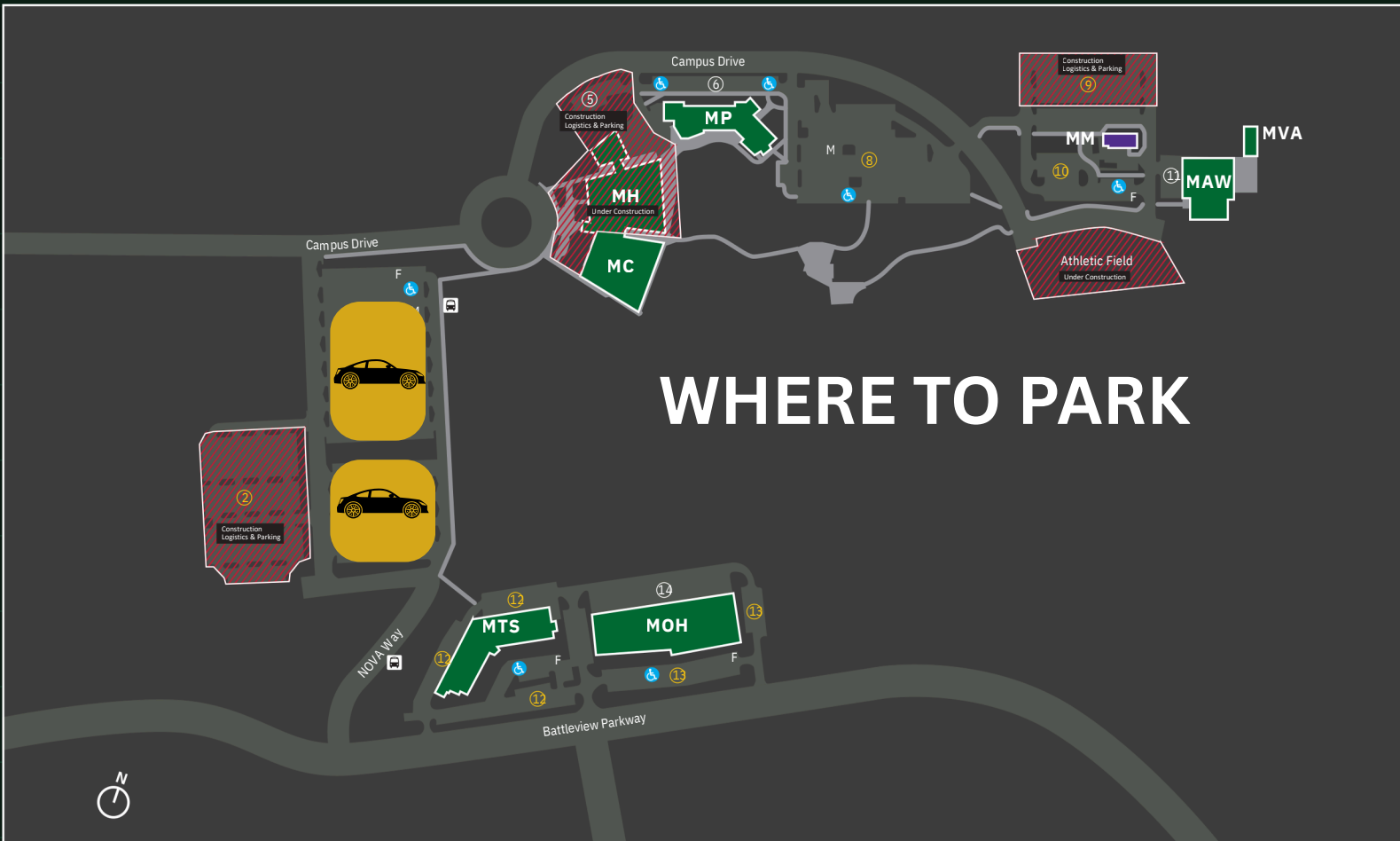
Scratch (Beginner-Friendly) - Sony Headphones

Apply coding concepts through a block-based programming platform

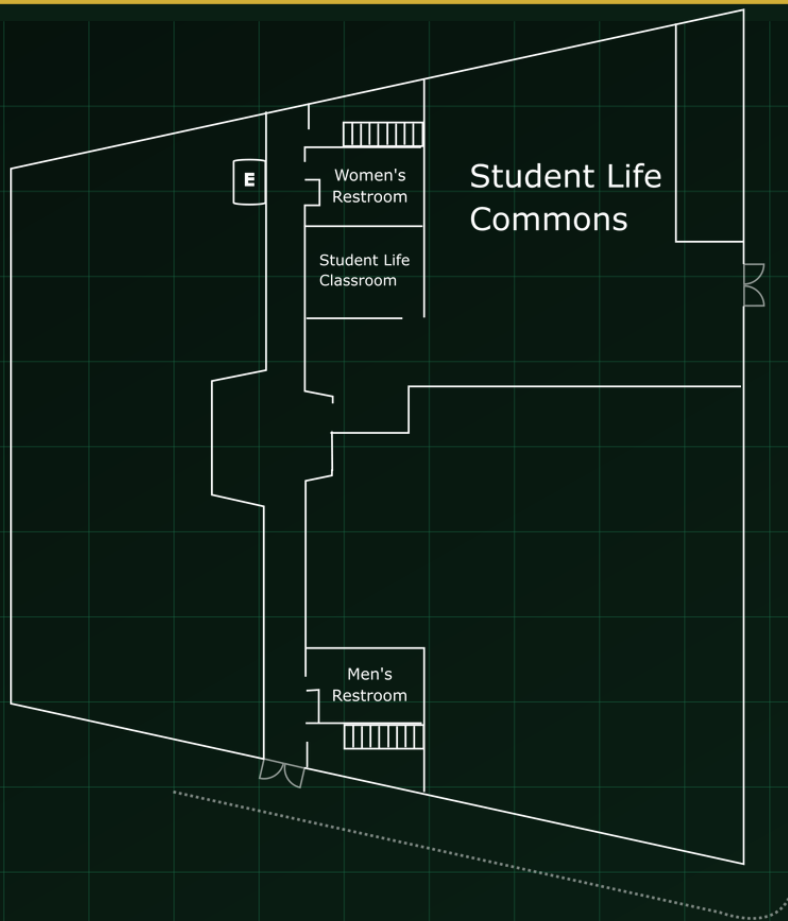
Best Overall - Espresso Machine

The top project out of all three tracks based on the creativity and constraints.

Campus Parking



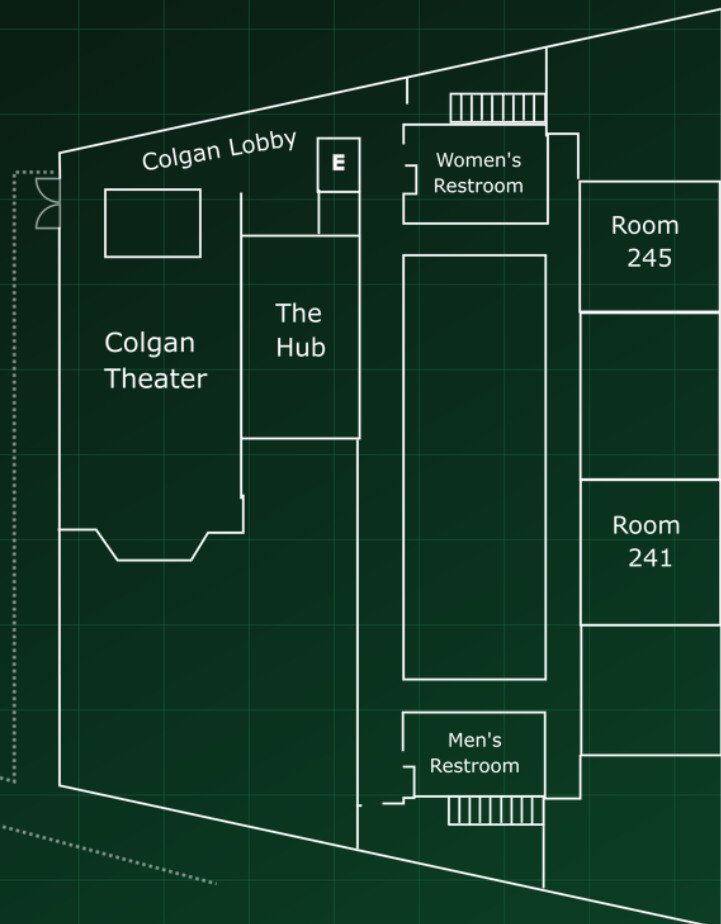
Colgan Layout



Bottom Floor

Middle Floor

Event
Entrance



Sponsor Spotlight

■ Sponsor Spotlight

■ Powered by Dominion Energy

We are incredibly grateful to have **Dominion Energy** as our presenting sponsor! As one of the nation's largest energy producers and distributors, their commitment to innovation, sustainability, and technology makes them the perfect partner.

■ Don't miss it: Dominion Energy presentation at 12:00 PM in the Student Life Area — lunch, exclusive career insights, and opportunities await!



**Thak you to NVCC Manassas
SGA & Student Life
For Prizes**

**Thak you to NVCC Manassas
Systemic For Arduino Kits**

■ Free Hacker Resources

All tools below are **free** for every participant. Use them to build faster!

Cursor cursor.com AI-powered code editor with intelligent completion & generation.	Google Gemini gemini.google.com Google's AI for research, ideation, and multimodal tasks.
Claude claude.ai Anthropic's AI assistant for coding help, debugging, and brainstorming.	Anti Gravity https://antigravity.google/download AI platform for hackers access details in the Discord server.
Claude Code https://code.claude.com/docs/en/quickstart Full codebase-aware AI pair programmer right in your terminal.	Google Stitch https://stitch.withgoogle.com/ Best for User Interface design.



■ DUCK HUNT RAFFLE! ■

Rubber ducks are hidden throughout Colgan Hall!



■ COLLECT

Find ducks hidden anywhere

■ ENTER

Each duck = one raffle entry

■ WIN

Raffle announced at Closing Ceremony

■ Frequently Asked Questions

Q Do I need a team?

Absolutly!! You need a team of 3 people, not one more, nor one less. No team yet? No worries we'll have a team formation opportunity during our pathways workshops!

Q What tracks are available?

Choose the track that best fits your skill level / what you are intrested in!: Hardware, Scratch, or Software.

Q I still have questions what do I do?

Join our Discord and ask. Organizers will also be identifiable on-site and happy to assist!

Q

**Good luck, build
something awesome,
and have a great time!**